

Athletic Disordered Eating (ADE) Scale

Buckley GL, Lassemillante AM, Cooke MB, Belski R. *The Development and Validation of a Disordered Eating Screening Tool for Current and Former Athletes: The Athletic Disordered Eating (ADE) Screening Tool*. *Nutrients*. 2024 Aug 19;16(16):2758. <https://doi.org/10.3390/nu16162758>

Fatt, S.J., Prnjak, K., Buckley, G.L., George, E., Hay, P., Jeacocke, N. and Mitchison, D. (2024), *Further Validation for a Measure of Disordered Eating in an Independent Sample of Male and Female Elite Athletes: The Athletic Disordered Eating (ADE) Scale*. *Int J Eat Disord*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/eat.24344>

Subscale 1: food and energy control

1. I feel bad when an athlete has a better-looking body than mine
2. I am dissatisfied with my body size or shape
3. I compare my body to other athletes or my former self
4. My performance or mood is influenced by how I feel about my body
5. I fear fat gain or muscle loss

Subscale 2: bingeing

6. Once I start eating, I find it hard to stop
7. There are certain foods I can not control myself around
8. I overeat when I am allowed to eat freely, i.e., off-season or a buffet

Subscale 3: body control

9. I am motivated to train harder to influence my body shape or weight
10. I will perform extra exercise to influence my body shape
11. I look to control my food when I want more out of my body
12. To change my body, I cut back on foods or ingredients

Subscale 4: body discontent

13. I carefully plan and think about what I eat
14. I avoid social situations if there will be foods I do not feel comfortable eating
15. I find spontaneous eating decisions challenging
16. If I have not exercised that day I will limit my food
17. I think about the calories/kilojoules I am burning when I train or exercise

Scores:

5-point Likert scale (0 = *Never* to 4 = *Always*)

- the full scale (summed for a possible range of 0–68)
- subscale *food and energy control* (range: 0–20)
- subscale *bingeing* (range: 0–12)
- subscale *body control* (range: 0–16)
- subscale *body discontent* (range: 0–20)

Cut off's: four levels of disordered eating risk:

1. minimal risk (total ADE < 25)
2. moderate risk (ADE = 25–32)
3. high risk (ADE = 33–44) (**suggested overall cutoff score ≥ 33**)
4. very high risk (ADE > 44)

The scale is suitable to detect clinically significant changes in DE indication with a score change of seven or greater.